

RELIEVE

1. Passage anchor

> “...at a time when I was feeling both ****relieved**** and uncertain about what would come next.”

Passage meaning

****relieved**** = feeling less worried, tense, or anxious because something difficult or unpleasant has ended or turned out well

****如釋重負的；鬆了一口氣的；安心的****

The base verb is:

****relieve**** = make worry, pain, pressure, or difficulty less severe

****減輕；緩解；解除****

Practice

1. I felt ****relieved**** when the exams were finally over.

考試終於結束時，我感到****如釋重負****。

2. Her message ****relieved**** some of my anxiety.

她的訊息****減輕了****我的一些焦慮。

Core meanings of RELIEVE

2. relieve — reduce pain, discomfort, stress, or worry

= make something unpleasant less severe

****減輕；緩解****

Examples

1. This medicine helps ****relieve pain****.

這種藥有助於****緩解疼痛****。

2. Talking to someone can ****relieve stress****.

和別人談談可以****減輕壓力****。

This is the central modern sense.

3. relieve pain

= make physical pain less severe

****止痛；緩解疼痛****

Examples

1. The treatment helped ****relieve the pain****.
治療有助於****緩解疼痛****。

2. A warm bath may ****relieve muscle pain****.
熱水澡可能有助於****減輕肌肉疼痛****。

4. relieve stress / tension / anxiety

= reduce mental or emotional pressure

****減輕壓力 / 緊張 / 焦慮****

Examples

1. Exercise can ****relieve stress****.
運動可以****減輕壓力****。

2. The good news ****relieved her anxiety****.
那個好消息****緩解了她的焦慮****。

Free someone from worry

5. relieve someone

= make someone feel less worried or anxious

****使某人安心；使某人鬆一口氣****

Examples

1. The doctor's words ****relieved her****.
醫生的話讓她****安心了****。

2. I was greatly ****relieved**** to hear that everyone was safe.
聽到大家都平安，我感到非常****如釋重負****。

6. be relieved

= feel less worried because a problem has ended or danger has passed

****感到如釋重負；鬆一口氣****

Examples

1. I was ****relieved**** when I passed the exam.

我通過考試後感到****鬆了一口氣****。

2. She looked ****relieved**** after hearing the result.

她聽到結果後看起來****放心了****。

This is the exact passage branch.

7. relieved to hear / know / see

= pleased and less worried because of new information

****聽到 / 知道 / 看到.....而感到安心****

Examples

1. I was ****relieved to hear**** that he was okay.

聽到他沒事，我感到****很安心****。

2. She was ****relieved to know**** the problem had been solved.

知道問題已經解決，她感到****如釋重負****。

Very common pattern.

Remove a burden / responsibility

8. relieve someone of a duty / responsibility

= remove a duty or responsibility from someone

****解除某人的職責；免去某人的責任****

Examples

1. He was ****relieved of his duties****.

他被****解除職務****。

2. The assistant **relieved her of some responsibility**.
助手幫她**分擔了一些責任**。

9. relieve someone of a burden

= take away or reduce a burden
減輕某人的負擔

Examples

1. The extra support **relieved her of a heavy burden**.
額外的支援**減輕了她沉重的負擔**。

2. Sharing the work helped **relieve him of some pressure**.
分擔工作有助於**減輕他的一些壓力**。

Replace someone on duty

10. relieve someone

= replace someone who is working so they can stop or rest
接替；換班

Examples

1. Another guard came to **relieve him** at midnight.
另一名警衛半夜來**接替他**。

2. I'll **relieve you** at six.
我六點來**接你的班**。

Distinct work-duty sense.

11. relieve a guard / worker

= take over that person's duty
接替值班人員；換班

Examples

1. The night team **relieved the day shift**.

夜班人員**接替了日班**。

2. A second officer arrived to **relieve the first**.

第二名警員到場**接替第一名警員**。

Military

12. relieve a place / unit

= free soldiers or a position from pressure, attack, or siege, often by replacing or assisting them

解圍；增援；接替

Examples

1. Reinforcements arrived to **relieve the city**.

援軍抵達，為城市**解圍**。

2. Fresh troops were sent to **relieve the exhausted unit**.

新部隊被派去**接替那支疲憊的部隊**。

Established military sense, lower priority for general learners.

Bodily functions

13. relieve yourself

= urinate or defecate

大小便；去洗手間

Examples

1. He stopped by the roadside to **relieve himself**.

他在路邊停下來**方便一下**。

2. The dog went outside to **relieve itself**.

那隻狗到外面**排泄**。

Euphemistic.

Pressure / congestion

14. relieve pressure

= reduce physical, mechanical, social, or mental pressure

****減壓；降低壓力****

Examples

1. The valve is designed to ****relieve pressure****.
這個閥門是用來****釋放壓力****的。
2. The new road may ****relieve traffic pressure**** in the city centre.
新道路可能有助於****減輕市中心的交通壓力****。

15. relieve congestion

= reduce overcrowding or blockage

****緩解擠塞；減少壅塞****

Examples

1. The new line should ****relieve traffic congestion****.
新路線應該能****緩解交通擠塞****。
2. The medicine may help ****relieve nasal congestion****.
這種藥可能有助於****緩解鼻塞****。

Same core concept, but useful domain extension.

Poverty / hardship

16. relieve suffering

= reduce suffering or hardship

****減輕痛苦；救濟****

Examples

1. The charity works to ****relieve suffering****.
這個慈善機構致力於****減輕苦難****。

2. Emergency aid helped **relieve hardship**.

緊急援助有助於**減輕困苦**。

17. relieve poverty

= reduce poverty or hardship

救濟貧困；減輕貧困

Examples

1. The programme was designed to **relieve poverty**.

該計畫旨在**減輕貧困**。

2. Local charities helped **relieve poverty** in the area.

當地慈善機構協助**救濟區內貧困**。

More formal.

Related forms

18. relieved

= feeling less worried or anxious after a problem, danger, or uncertainty ends

如釋重負的；安心的

Examples

1. She looked **relieved**.

她看起來**鬆了一口氣**。

2. We were all **relieved** when the news arrived.

消息傳來時，我們都**放心了**。

19. relief

A. reduction of pain, worry, or difficulty

緩解；減輕

1. The medicine brought immediate ****relief****.

藥物立即帶來了****緩解****。

B. feeling of reassurance after worry ends

****安心；如釋重負****

2. To my ****relief****, everyone was safe.

令我****鬆一口氣的是****，大家都平安。

C. aid for people in hardship

****救濟；援助****

3. Emergency ****relief**** was sent to the area.

****緊急救援物資****被送到該地區。

20. relief work / relief aid

= help provided to people affected by disaster, war, poverty, etc.

****救援工作；救濟援助****

Examples

1. Volunteers took part in ****relief work****.

義工參與了****救援工作****。

2. The region received emergency ****relief aid****.

該地區獲得了緊急****救濟援助****。

21. relieving

= reducing pain, pressure, worry, etc.

****舒緩的；減輕……的****

Examples

1. Stretching can have a ****relieving effect**** on tension.

拉筋可能對緊張有****舒緩作用****。

2. It was deeply ****relieving**** to finally talk about it.

終於能談起這件事，讓人非常****釋然****。

Less common than ****relieved****.

Important contrast: relieved vs relieving

22. relieved vs relieving

****relieved****

= describes the person who feels less worried

****感到安心的****

****relieving****

= describes something that reduces worry or discomfort

****令人舒緩的****

Compare:

> I felt ****relieved****.

> 我感到如釋重負。

> The news was ****relieving****.

> 那個消息讓人感到安心。

In natural English, ****reassuring**** is often more common than ****relieving**** for news or information.

High-value expressions

23. to someone's relief

= making someone feel less worried

****令某人鬆一口氣的是****

Examples

1. ****To my relief****, the exam was easier than expected.

****令我鬆一口氣的是****，考試比預期容易。

2. ****To everyone's relief****, the child was found safe.

****令大家安心的是****，那個孩子平安被找到。

24. sigh of relief

= breath showing that worry or tension has ended

****鬆一口氣；如釋重負地嘆氣****

Examples

1. She gave a ****sigh of relief****.

她****鬆了一口氣****。

2. Everyone breathed a ****sigh of relief**** when the result came out.

結果公布後，大家都****如釋重負地鬆了一口氣****。

25. breathe a sigh of relief

= visibly relax after worry ends

****鬆一口氣****

Examples

1. I ****breathed a sigh of relief**** when I saw my score.

看到成績時，我****鬆了一口氣****。

2. The team could finally ****breathe a sigh of relief****.

團隊終於可以****鬆一口氣****。

Key contrasts

26. relieve vs release

****relieve****

= make pain, pressure, worry, or difficulty less severe

****減輕；緩解****

****release****

= let something or someone go free, or allow something to escape

****釋放；放走****

Compare:

> relieve pressure

> 減輕 / 釋放壓力

> release a prisoner

> 釋放囚犯

There is overlap in physical pressure contexts, but they are not generally interchangeable.

27. relieve vs reduce

****reduce****

= make something smaller in amount, degree, size, etc.

****減少****

****relieve****

= specifically make something unpleasant, painful, burdensome, or pressured less severe

****緩解 ; 減輕****

Compare:

> reduce costs

> 降低成本

> relieve pain

> 緩解疼痛

28. relieve vs ease

****ease****

= make something less severe, difficult, or uncomfortable

****緩和 ; 減輕****

****relieve****

= very similar, especially with pain, stress, pressure, and symptoms

Compare:

> ease the pain

> relieve the pain

Both can mean ****減輕疼痛****.

****Relieve**** often sounds slightly more formal/medical.

29. relieve vs reassure

****reassure****

= say or do something that makes someone feel less worried

****使安心；安撫****

****relieve****

= remove or reduce the worry itself

****減輕焦慮；使鬆一口氣****

Compare:

> The doctor ****reassured**** me that everything was normal.

> 醫生安慰我一切正常。

> That news ****relieved**** me.

> 那個消息讓我鬆了一口氣。

30. relieved vs relaxed

****relieved****

= worry or tension decreases because a particular problem has ended or become less serious

****如釋重負的****

****relaxed****

= generally calm and free from tension

****放鬆的****

Compare:

> I felt ****relieved**** when the exam ended.

> 考試結束時，我鬆了一口氣。

> I felt ****relaxed**** during the holiday.

> 假期期間我感到很放鬆。

31. relieved vs happy

****happy****

= generally pleased

****開心的****

****relieved****

= specifically pleased because worry, danger, pressure, or uncertainty has ended

****鬆了一口氣的****

A person can be relieved without being especially happy.

Meaning map

The central concept of ****relieve**** is:

****remove or reduce something unpleasant, burdensome, or pressuring****

From this develop:

Pain

relieve pain

→ ****緩解疼痛****

Stress

relieve stress

→ ****減輕壓力****

Emotion

relieve someone

→ ****讓某人安心****

Passage adjective

feel relieved

→ ****感到如釋重負****

Responsibility

relieve someone of duties

→ ****解除職責****

Work

relieve a guard

→ **接替值班**

Military

relieve a unit/city

→ **增援 / 解圍**

Physical pressure

relieve pressure

→ **減壓**

Hardship

relieve suffering/poverty

→ **減輕苦難 / 救濟**

Bodily euphemism

relieve yourself

→ **去洗手間 / 排泄**

The passage uses the emotional result:

important exams ended

→ **pressure disappeared**

→ **the speaker felt relieved**

MCQ-ready master list

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
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relieve — reduce pain/discomfort	使疼痛、不適等變得較輕；緩解 / 減輕
relieve stress/tension/anxiety	減輕精神壓力、緊張或焦慮
relieve someone — emotion	使某人因擔憂減少而感到安心
be relieved	因危險、壓力或不確定性結束而感到如釋重負
relieved to hear/know/see	因聽到 / 知道 / 看到某好消息而感到安心
relieve someone of duties	解除某人的工作、職責或責任
relieve someone of a burden	替某人減輕負擔
relieve someone — work duty	接替正在值班或工作的人
relieve a military unit/place	接替、增援或為被圍困的部隊 / 地方解圍
relieve yourself	委婉指大小便 / 去洗手間
relieve pressure	釋放或減低物理、機械或心理壓力
relieve congestion	減少交通、鼻腔等的擁堵 / 阻塞

relieve suffering/hardship	減輕痛苦或困苦	
relieve poverty	減輕 / 救濟貧困	
relieved	感到安心、鬆了一口氣、如釋重負的	
relief — easing	疼痛、壓力或困難的緩解	
relief — emotional	擔憂消失後的安心 / 如釋重負	
relief — aid	對災民、貧困者等提供的救濟 / 援助	
relief work/aid	救援工作 / 救濟援助	
to someone's relief	令某人鬆一口氣的是.....	
sigh of relief	表示擔憂消失的鬆一口氣	
breathe a sigh of relief	因危機或擔憂解除而鬆一口氣	

Passage recap

> “...I was feeling both ****relieved**** and uncertain about what would come next.”

Here:

****relieved**** = ****feeling less worried and tense because the exams had ended****

Best Traditional Chinese:

* ****如釋重負的****

* ****鬆了一口氣的****

* ****安心的****

Natural contextual translation:

****當時的我一方面鬆了一口氣，但另一方面也對接下來會發生甚麼感到不確定。 ****

Passage MCQ-ready meaning

****relieved****

= ****feeling reassured and less anxious because something difficult, worrying, or stressful has ended****

****如釋重負的；鬆了一口氣的****

The key contrast is:

> ****relieved****

> → 原本有壓力 / 擔心，現在壓力解除

> ****relaxed****

> → 一般處於放鬆狀態

> **happy**

> → 一般感到開心

So in the passage, **relieved** is especially precise because the speaker has just **finished** an important set of final exams.